University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Autumn Semester 2025

7,041: Asia Compact: Fintech Innovation in Singapore and Southeast Asia (FISSA) (location: Singapore)

ECTS credits: 3

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Presentation, Analog, Group work individual grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Active participation, Digital, Individual work individual grade (20%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Written work, Digital, Individual work individual grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
7,041,1.00 Asia Compact: Fintech Innovation in Singapore and Southeast Asia (FISSA) (location: Singapore) -- English -- Njavro Mato

Course information

Prerequisites

The course has no prerequisites. Dr. Mato Njavro will be teaching this course between November 3 and November 7, 2025 in Singapore at the St.Gallen Institute of Management in Asia (SGI-HSG).

Students are required to arrive to Singapore no later than 2nd of November (Sunday) and leave no earlier than 7 th of November (Friday) evening. Registration and admission into the course will be separate from the regular bidding process. In order to select the most motivated students for the course, I ask you to submit your CV and a short motivation statement explaining why you would like to take the course (1/2 page maximum). Please send this to mato.njavro@unisg.ch. The bidding window will be open from **August 6 (Wednesday), 6:00pm CET and August 25 (Monday), 2025, 11:59PM CET.**

Learning objectives

- This course will cover the history of fintech and provide a detailed understanding of the current fintech landscape.
- Participants will get an understanding of various segments of fintech, including Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Lending, crowdfunding, digital wealth management (robo-advisors), Blockchain & Cryptocurrencies and Insurance Technology (i.e. InsurTech).
- Through a combination of case studies, guest lectures and company visits, participants will get an in-depth insight into the dynamic fintech ecosystem of Singapore and Southeast Asia.

Content

This course on Fintech (financial technology) Innovation in Singapore and Southeast Asia will take place in Singapore during the autumn break.

The course has a focus on Fintech industry and its unique and rapidly evolving ecosystem in Singapore and Southeast Asia. Ever since the global financial crisis of 2008, the new breed of companies operating at the intersection of financial services and technology sector, have been revolutionising the way we think about many aspects of financial services. By focusing on innovative, customer-centric, inclusive and technology-driven business models, these companies are challenging the traditional paradigms of financial industry. Asia is at the forefront of this fintech revolution. In particular China, with its above average economic growth, huge and digitally-savvy population and unsophisticated banking system proved to be a fertile ground for fintech innovation at a massive scale. Chinese (fin)tech giants, Ant Financial (with Alipay platform) and Tencent (with WeChat platform), have engineered a spectacular leapfrog of Chinese consumers from cash to mobile payment. QR codes are now

ubiquitous in China and paying for goods and services without being plugged-in the Chinese mobile payment ecosystem can sometimes prove difficult.
Southeast Asia is another dynamic hotbed for fintech innovation, supported by massive (more than 600 million), mostly young and increasingly urban population and high internet and mobile adoption. Taken together, the 10 member states of ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) represent a major economic powerhouse as well as a huge market for various financial services.

At the centre of this fintech revolution in Southeast Asia is Singapore - a city state that in many ways represents the epitome of economic development, innovation and growth. With no natural resources except its human capital and geographic location, Singapore achieved a spectacular transformation from a 'third world' to a 'first world' country, within the space of one generation. In this process, the structure of the Singaporean economic landscape has changed from one powered by industrialization (in the early years after the independence) to the current one powered by services, knowledge and innovation. Already a global financial hub, Singapore introduced policies and incentives aimed at fostering dynamic fintech ecosystem. With its progressive regulatory framework, the city has positioned itself as a preferred gateway to Asia for the global fintech industry. This course will cover the history of fintech and provide a detailed understanding of the current fintech landscape. Participants will get an understanding of various segments of fintech, including Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Lending, crowdfunding, digital wealth management (robo-advisors), Blockchain & Cryptocurrencies and Insurance Technology (i.e. InsurTech). Through a combination of case studies, guest lectures and company visits, participants will get an in-depth insight into the dynamic fintech ecosystem of Singapore and Southeast Asia.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

- This course counts 3 credits. Accordingly, the total workload for students is 90 hours. This includes self-study, campus time and all examinations.
- The course is conducted in hybrid format and in blended learning format via StudyNet.

The course starts with a **mandatory introductory kick-off session that will take place via Zoom.** The **core part of the course** will be taught during the **second week of the mid-term break**, from 3-7th of November in Singapore, at the St. Gallen Institute of Management in Asia. This is the local institute of the University of St.Gallen **in Singapore** (www.singapore.unisg.ch).

In addition to formal lectures, the course relies on case studies, recent research studies, current reports and media coverage and insights from domain experts as well as company visits. Thus, the course combines classic in-class teaching with a study mission character. In addition, several extra-curricular activities (non-compulsory) will be offered in order to expose the participants to other dimensions of Singapore and foster their cross-cultural understanding and skills. For further information and to find out when the next course takes place, please refer to the course information sheet on the HSG website under course directory.

Literature

Relevant literature (articles, case studies, etc.) will be distributed at the beginning of semester.

Additional information

The trip to Singapore is NOT sponsored. Participants have to cover their travel expenses (flight, hotel etc.) on their own. Total costs for flight and accommodation during the stay in Singapore are expected to be in the range of approx. 1,000CHF to 1,500CHF (based on students' feedback of previous years). Singapore offers a wide variety of accommodation ranging from hostels to hotels and private residences as well as direct flights and stopover flights. Further, it is the students' responsibility to have a valid travel insurance for their stay in Singapore.

Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Presentation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination

Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Group work individual grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
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Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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2. Examination sub part (2/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Active participation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	20%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
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Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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3. Examination sub part (3/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written work
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written work
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

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Examination-aid rule

Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids

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Content

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Literature

Relevant literature (articles, case studies, etc.) will be distributed at the beginning of semester.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW51) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 43 (Freitag, 24. October 2025) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 34 (Thursday, 21 August 2025);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 42 (Monday, 13. October 2025);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 43 (Freitag, 24. October 2025);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 45 (Monday, 03. November 2025).